Cluster Development at Mukteshwar Region

Site visit to TRISHA Center, Mukteshwar

TRISHA

(TERI's Research Initiative at Supi for Himalayan Advancement)

At TERI resource center with DR. NARAYAN SING (PROJECT MANAGER) & BACHI SIGH GAIRA (SENIOR SUPERVISOR (FIELD) 24th December 2018.

Introduction to supi village:

According to Census 2011 information the location code or village code of Supi village is 054733. Supi village is located in Nainital Tehsil of Nainital district in Uttarakhand, India. It is situated 45km away from Nainital, which is both district & sub-district headquarter of Supi village. As per 2009 stats, Supi village is also a gram panchayat.

The total geographical area of village is 606.08 hectares. Supi has a total population of 2,077 peoples. There are about 364 houses in Supi village. Bhowali is nearest town to Supi which is approximately 26km away.

Supi village view from **TERI TRISHA CENTER.** 24 December 2018.

Role of TERI in supi village: Farmers here face the typical challenges of water scarcity, unpredictable weather, pest infestation, man-animal conflict and low crop productivity.

TRISHA introduced the farmers to a set of new practices that brought resource use efficiency in agriculture and at the same time improved their farm incomes. The farmers of Supi typically grow crops like potato and cabbage which are input heavy, but do not give adequate returns.

Polyhouses at TRISHA.

The TRISHA centre at Supi has a number of glasshouses and poly houses to raise nurseries of high-quality plant varieties which are then made available to the farmers.

With TERI's support, they are now cultivating herbs and aromatic crops like geranium, rosemary, oregano, parsley etc. These crops can be grown almost throughout the year in fallow land, require significantly less water and other agricultural inputs and are less likely to be attacked by animals.

TERI also started conversations with farmers to revive their traditional crops like millets and rajma. It created a live seed bank by sourcing nearly 82 landraces from different regions of Kumaon.

The farmers were not only supplied with seeds and high-quality planting material, but were also sensitized about the high nutritional value of these crops. These efforts resulted in nearly 38% increase in the production of millets and 45% increase in the case of pulses.

In addition, a number of farmers have been introduced to poly houses themselves and government also giving subsidy to encourage more villagers, including the more effective Passive Solar Green Houses, which protect crops like tomato, peppermint and broccoli from adverse weather conditions like frost and low temperatures and also other challenges like pest attacks. The poly houses have resulted in high yields of good quality herbs like rosemary.

Farmers are also beginning to plant Napier grass which not only prevents soil erosion but can also be used as fodder for livestock. In an increasingly water scarce region which is primarily dependent on monsoons, TERI has introduced farmers to rainwater harvesting practices and many other villages also adopted this technique and collected water is used for 3 to 5 months for agriculture and daily needs.

TERI has created polythene tanks which can store up to 12,500 litres of rainwater at a time. This helps the farmers meet their domestic and critical irrigation needs. While some of these polythene tanks collect rainwater directly, others collect it from specially designed rooftop water harvesting systems which includes a drainage pipe that directs rainwater into these tanks thereby reducing wastage.

Rainwater harvesting collection system at TERI resource center, supi.

A low cost, gravity based drip irrigation system, which delivers water right to the roots of the crops have helped some farmers to increase their water use efficiency by 4 times, in growing vegetables and horticultural crops.

TERI has introduced, in Supi village, a biomass gasifier, vermicompost unit and an oil distillery to extract oil from crops like geranium as well as solar dryers for premium quality drying of herbs.

Oil distillation unit to extract oil from crops like geranium.

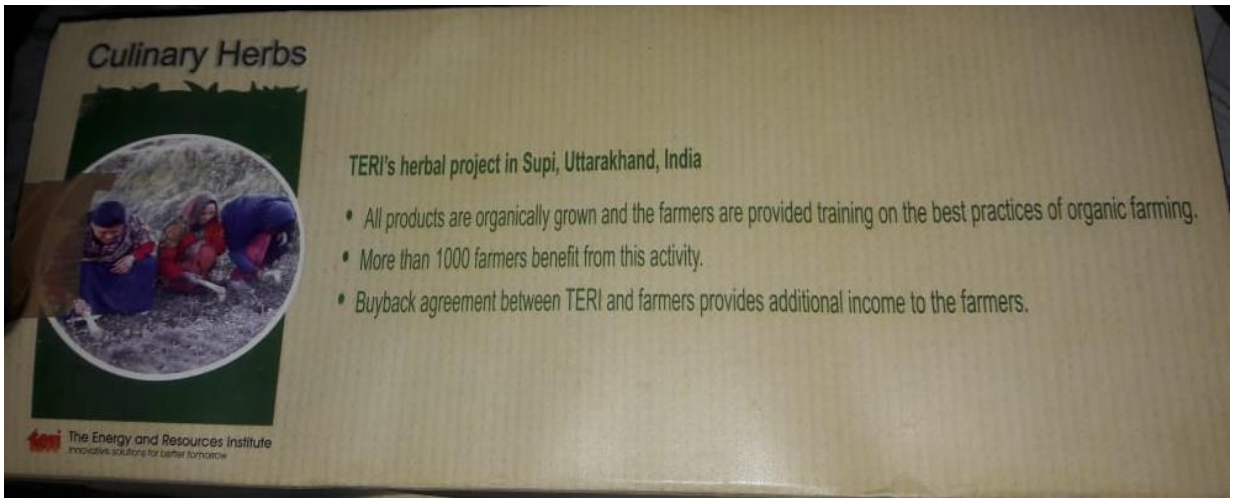
Kumaon vani community Radio station (KVCRS) (our radio our voice) 90.4MHz.

A community radio was established at TERI center covering 10km around the center. Providing services and sharing knowledge on air to villagers. Inviting community people to FM station discussing problems and other activities like interacting and recordings of farmers on fields to air.

At KVCRS MR.Narayan singh(Editing coordinator).

SUPI SUGANDH

TERI provides the market linkages for farmers by buying produced crops and manufacturing herbal teas and organics products for daily uses.

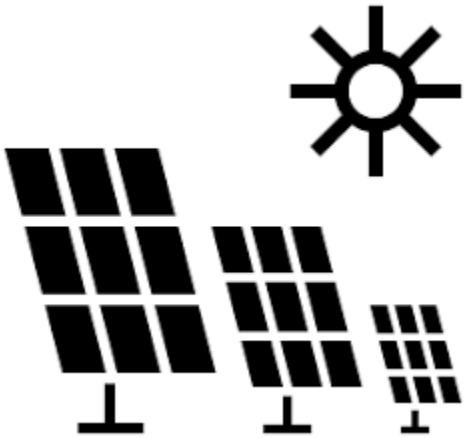


Different products at TERI supi center.

Since 2003 TERI helped farmers in supi and surrounding villages in sustainable agriculture practices and introducing affordable technologies. Now it’s time to make a model for smart village by establishing Cluster development model center.

Things I observed high intensity sun light which generates solar power.

Installing solar plant at the entrance gate for charging electrical vehicles for the mobility facility to the villagers.



Supi village people 25th December 2018.

We are very thankful to the team of TRISHA for sharing knowledge on sustainable agriculture practices.

A detailed project report is prepared and carry forward for sustainable development of rural clusters in India.

References:

1. Villageinfo.in. (2018). Supi Village in Nainital (Nainital) Uttarakhand |villageinfo.in.
2. Teriin.org. (2018). Seeds of Hope. [online] Available at: http://www.teriin.org/seeds-of-hope [Accessed 27 Dec. 2018].

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Available Facilities -
Herbal Products
Herbal Garden
Protected Cultivation Techniques
Medicinal and Aromatic Cultivation
Rain Water Harvesting Techniques
Bee Keeping
Advance Scientific Horticulture/
Agriculture Practices
Planting Material of Horticulture,
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